

September

8

1966

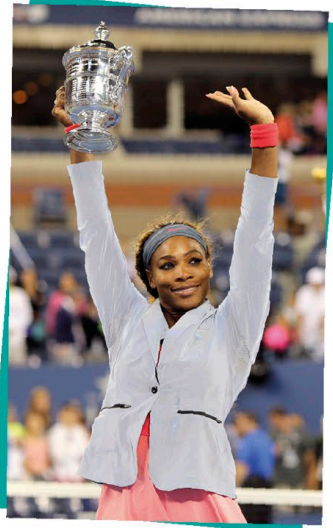
Star Trek

The first episode of the science-fiction TV show *Star Trek* aired on US television. The show ran for only three seasons, but grew in popularity in the following years, leading to several spin-off shows and films.

2013

Sporting champion

After winning the women's singles at the 2013 US Open, Black American tennis player Serena Williams became the world's highest-earning sportswoman, with prize money totalling more than US \$50 million. This was her 17th career Grand Slam title.



Also on this day

1504 The statue of David, a masterpiece by Michelangelo, was unveiled outside the Palazzo Vecchio in Florence, Italy.

2020 The world's first lightsaber, resembling the fictional weapon from the *Star Wars* series, was created by Canada's Hacksmith Industries.

1916

Riding for a cause

Sisters Augusta and Adeline Van Buren completed an 8,900 km (5,500 mile) ride across the USA on their motorcycles to promote the idea that women could be employed as military riders during the ongoing World War I.



Born this day

1979 Alecia Beth Moore, US singer and songwriter. Known by her stage name P!nk, she has sold more than 90 million records worldwide.